elmenue in the Egyptian market

What the market charges, what it costs you to run and sell it, what you must pay and register, and how to price and launch.

How to read this document. Every number is tagged. **[S]** = found in a public source (listed at the end; many are vendor blogs, so treat as indicative). **[E]** = my own estimate or assumption that you must check with real quotes. Exchange rate used: about **50 EGP per USD** [S: ~49.9 on 10 Aug 2026, 52-week range 46.6-54.8].

1. Executive summary

- **The market is real and already paid for.** Cloud restaurant POS systems in Egypt are advertised at about 1,000-5,000 EGP per month [S], restaurant online-ordering platforms at 28,000-45,000 EGP per year [S], and even simple QR menus at 100-200 EGP per month [S]. Venues are used to paying every month.
- **Your angle is a one-time price.** A venue paying a cloud POS 2,000-3,000 EGP/month spends 72,000-108,000 EGP over three years [S/E arithmetic]. A one-time 20,000-80,000 EGP package with no monthly fee is a strong, easy-to-explain offer.
- **The biggest gap is Egyptian tax e-receipts (ETA).** Depending on turnover and the current phase decision, some cafes and restaurants must issue electronic receipts to the Egyptian Tax Authority in 2026 [S, sources conflict]. elmenue does not do this yet. Until it does, you can safely sell to venues that are not yet covered, and you should not promise ETA compliance.
- **Hosting is cheap if you design it right.** One small server (about 500-1,000 EGP per month [E]) can host many venues. The Vercel free plan cannot be used commercially; Vercel Pro plus Supabase Pro is about 45 USD (about 2,250 EGP) per month before usage [S].
- **Start-up costs are small.** Registration and licences for a sole proprietorship are in the hundreds to low thousands of EGP [S]; a company costs about 5,000-15,000+ EGP in fees [S]. Your largest cost is your own time and the support you give in the first months.
- **Break-even is about 3 venues** on my model (section 7), so the plan is low-risk if you keep costs lean and sell to 10+ venues in the first year.

Recommended one-time prices (detail in section 6): **Starter 20,000 EGP, Standard 40,000 EGP, Premium 80,000 EGP**, extra branch at 50%, optional yearly support at 12% of the licence, hardware sold at cost plus a margin.

2. The Egyptian market and what competitors charge

Egypt has many POS, QR-menu and online-ordering vendors, from tiny menu-only tools to full cloud POS brands. Prices below come from public vendor pages and comparison blogs written by vendors, so they are marketing figures, not audited prices.

Product type	Price seen [S]	What you get	Where you compare
QR menu only (no ordering)	OrOMenu 99.50 EGP/month or 899.50/yr; Orders Egypt 200 EGP/month, 1,500/yr	Digital menu, WhatsApp order link	Your guest ordering, bill split, kitchen board are far beyond this
QR ordering by order	Queno: no subscription, small flat fee per completed order	QR ordering for cafes and food courts	Closest to a no-subscription model; fees grow with sales
QR + POS (blog estimate)	300-1,500 EGP/month	Menu + cashier integration	Mid-market reference for small venues
Cloud restaurant POS	Basic 1,000-2,000; mid 2,000-3,000; premium 3,000-5,000+ EGP/month. Foodics Starter 1,506 EGP/month (quarterly/annual billing)	POS, tables, reports, often hardware extra	Your main competitor set (Foodics, Geidea, Odoo and local vendors)
Odoo POS	About 1,200-1,500 EGP per user per month	ERP-grade, ETA e-receipt modules via partners	Complex and per-user priced

Product type	Price seen [S]	What you get	Where you compare
Online ordering platform	Launch 28,000 EGP/yr (2 branches); Scale 45,000 EGP/yr (5 branches)	Own domain, delivery, loyalty, reports	Delivery-focused; you do dine-in ordering
On-premise / perpetual licence	10,000-30,000+ EGP one-time (blog)	Software installed at the venue	Directly comparable to your one-time model
Annual local POS	From 3,000 EGP/yr (PSR Basic); some cloud plans from 15,000 EGP/yr	Basic restaurant POS	Shows a low-end price floor

Hardware prices venues already expect to pay [S]

Item	Typical price (EGP)	Notes
POS terminal or tablet	5,000 - 15,000	Captain/cashier device
80 mm receipt printer	1,500 - 4,000	Egypt listings: Xprinter XP-Q838L 1,599-1,888; Gainscha GA-E200I 1,739; XP-80T 2,199; X-Printer D200 4,942
Thermal paper	929 for 40 rolls (7.9 cm)	Recurring consumable
Cash drawer	1,000 - 3,000	Usually connects through the printer
Kitchen display screen	2,000 - 5,000	Your kitchen screen can run on any tablet or cheap monitor + browser
Whole hardware set	7,500 - 22,000	Plus onboarding fee 500-2,000 at some vendors

What this means for you: because elmenue runs in any browser, a venue can use tablets or phones they already own. That removes the 7,500-22,000 EGP hardware wall that competitors rely on, and is a real selling point for small cafes.

3. What you pay to host and run it

There are three realistic ways to run the system. The right choice depends on how many venues you have and whether you want to carry the ongoing cost.

Model	Monthly cost	Pros	Cons
A. Local install at the venue (mini PC or old laptop on the cafe Wi-Fi)	0 EGP hosting. Pass-through hardware 6,000-15,000 EGP one-time [E]	No monthly cost for anyone; works if internet drops; data stays in the venue	You support on site; no easy remote access without a tunnel; push alerts and outside access need extra setup
B. Your own server for all venues (one VPS running multi-tenant mode)	About 500-1,000 EGP/month for the first 10-20 venues [E: small VPS, 10-20 USD]	Lowest cost per venue; one place to update and back up; you control everything	You are responsible for uptime, backups and security. Venue relies on internet
C. Vercel Pro + Supabase Pro (what the live demo uses, upgraded)	Vercel Pro 20 USD per user/month and Supabase Pro 25 USD/month = about 45 USD (about 2,250 EGP) plus usage [S]	Easy deploys, managed database, automatic scaling	Costs more; app polls instead of using live connections; current build serves one restaurant per deployment, so many venues need extra engineering [E]

Important: the Vercel free plan is for non-commercial use, so you must leave it before charging any venue [S]. The Supabase free plan has limits and no guaranteed backups.

Other running costs [E - get real quotes]

Item	Estimate	Why you need it
Domain name (.com or .com.eg)	600 - 1,500 EGP/year	yourbrand.com plus a sub-address per venue; QR codes must never change

Item	Estimate	Why you need it
Daily backups (off-site)	100 - 500 EGP/month	Losing a cafe sales history would end the business
Error and uptime monitoring	0 - 1,000 EGP/month	Know about a problem before the venue calls
SMS / WhatsApp business numbers	0 - 500 EGP/month	Support line; WhatsApp Business is free for basic use
Accountant / tax adviser	1,500 - 4,000 EGP/month or per filing	Tax card, VAT, yearly filing, invoices
Printed QR table stands	100 - 250 EGP per table, sold to the venue at a margin	Material, printing, stickers or acrylic
Payment gateway	Paid by the venue: about 2.75% + 3 EGP per card payment [S, unconfirmed which vendor]	Only if you add online card payments

4. Registration, legal and tax in Egypt

Sources for this section disagree in places and several are consultancy marketing. **Treat everything here as a checklist of questions for a local accountant and lawyer, not as answers.**

Business registration costs [S]

Step	Figure from sources	Comment
Sole proprietorship: name reservation	about 107 EGP	Cheapest way to start legally
Commercial register entry and copy	about 12.50 EGP + 200-500 EGP copy	Depends on declared capital
Chamber of Commerce annual fee	0.2% of declared capital; minimum 24, maximum 2,000 EGP; plus 100 EGP certificate	GAFI table is undated; confirm current
Commercial Syndicate	125 EGP (capital under 500,000) or 250 EGP	
Limited company (LLC) government fees	5,000 - 15,000+ EGP excluding professional help	Lawyer packages can be much higher
Tax card	One source says free via GAFI; no reliable fee found	A temporary tax card cannot issue e-invoices or e-receipts

Taxes to ask your accountant about [S]

- **Corporate tax:** general rate 22.5% of net profit [S]. Small-business rules under Law 152 of 2020 (and later amendments such as Law 30 of 2023) describe simplified turnover-based tax for small projects: an older summary says 1% of turnover for 3-10 million EGP businesses and a flat 1,000 EGP/year under 200,000 EGP. This summary is about six years old; confirm current rules.
- **VAT:** most sources say 14%. One source says registration is mandatory once annual revenue passes 500,000 EGP and quotes 15%. Ask your accountant which applies to you.
- **Freelancer route:** sources conflict (registration threshold quoted as 60,000 EGP per year; another says no tax below 15,000). If you sell as an individual, income is taxed as non-commercial professional income under Law 91 of 2005. A company or sole proprietorship is usually the better face for selling to businesses.
- **Your own e-invoicing:** one source lists independent software developers among service providers newly in scope of e-invoicing once annual revenue passes 250,000 EGP (ETA Resolution 281 of 2025). Plan to issue e-invoices for your own sales.
- **Invoices and contracts:** every sale should have a signed licence contract, a tax invoice, and a handover record (what was installed, logins, backup plan).

ETA e-receipts: the gate that decides who you can sell to

Egypt is rolling out electronic receipts for retail and restaurants in waves. Reports say: businesses above about 250,000 EGP annual revenue (some sources 500,000) are being brought in; one source says cafes and restaurants with 1-10 million EGP revenue are expected in Q3-Q4 2026; another says coverage depends on being named in a phase decision by sector and area rather than on a revenue number. QR codes on printed receipts are reported as required from January 2026. A vendor source claims receipts must be sent to ETA within 60 seconds with digital signatures, and a penalty of up to 10,000 EGP per violation (marketing claim; verify). [S, conflicting]

- **Today elmenue is not integrated with ETA.** A venue that is already covered cannot use it as its official cashier system.
- **What to do:** (1) ask every prospect whether they are already registered for e-receipts; (2) sell now to venues that are not covered and tell them the roadmap; (3) build the ETA integration as the first paid feature - estimate 3-6 weeks of development plus registration/testing with ETA [E], and the venue needs its own ETA registration and a signing credential. Alternatively partner with an existing e-receipt provider and resell.
- Competitors (Odoo partners, Foodics and others) already advertise ETA e-receipt support, so this feature will increasingly be asked for even by venues not yet forced.

5. What each sale costs you

Per venue (my estimate [E])	Cost	Notes
Setup, menu entry, QR printing, testing	6 - 10 hours of your time	Photos and menu from the venue; use Excel import and bulk photo upload
Training (owner + captains)	2 - 3 hours	Short video and printed card reduce this
Travel and misc.	300 - 800 EGP	Depends on city
First-month support (free)	3 - 6 hours	Fix, tweak, answer; includes a first busy weekend
Cash cost per venue (excluding your time)	about 1,500 EGP	Used in the financial model below

6. Recommended pricing (one-time, no subscription)

These prices are my proposal [E], anchored to what competitors charge in section 2. They are in EGP and the quote should expire in 7-14 days because the pound moves.

	Starter - 20,000 EGP	Standard - 40,000 EGP	Premium - 80,000 EGP
For	Small cafe, kiosk, takeaway (up to ~10 tables)	Cafe or restaurant (up to ~30 tables)	Large restaurant or lounge, multiple zones and staff
Guest QR ordering, split bill, Arabic + English	Yes	Yes	Yes
Captain and kitchen screens	Yes	Yes	Yes
POS, discounts, takeaway/delivery tickets	-	Yes	Yes
Inventory, low-stock alerts, reports and exports	Basic reports	Full	Full
Floor zones, reservations, roles	-	Zones	Zones + reservations + custom roles
Own branding, colours, layouts, photos setup	Logo + colours	Plus layouts and photos	Fully custom setup
Training and priority support	1 session	2 sessions	3 sessions + 3 months priority support
Extra branch	50% of licence	50% of licence	50% of licence

- **Optional yearly support and updates:** 12% of the licence per year (2,400 / 4,800 / 9,600 EGP). Offer it, do not force it, to keep the "no subscription" promise.
- **Hardware:** sell at cost plus 10-15%. Tablets, printers and stands are pass-through, not your main profit.
- **Add-ons:** printer and cash drawer setup 1,500-3,000 EGP; online card payments integration 3,000-8,000 EGP once built [E]; ETA e-receipt module (price when built); custom features 500-1,000 EGP per hour [E].
- **Payment terms:** 50% on signing, 50% at go-live. Pilot venues (first 2-3) get 30-40% off in exchange for a testimonial, photos and honest feedback.
- **Why not cheaper:** under about 15,000 EGP you will not cover support and travel, and low prices signal low quality to owners.

How you compare over three years (arithmetic from section 2 [S/E])

Option for a small cafe	3-year cost
Cloud POS at 1,000-3,000 EGP/month	36,000 - 108,000 EGP (plus hardware 7,500-22,000)
Online ordering platform 28,000 EGP/year	84,000 EGP
QR menu only (200 EGP/month)	7,200 EGP, but no ordering, POS or kitchen
elmenue Standard one-time + optional support	**40,000 EGP + 0 to 14,400 EGP support**

7. Your costs and revenue model (year 1)

All figures are my assumptions [E] in EGP. The average licence sold is 35,000 EGP (a mix of the three packages). Taxes and your own salary are not included.

Fixed yearly cost	EGP	Assumption
Server hosting (Model B, with growth)	12,000	About 1,000 EGP/month
Domain and monitoring	4,000	
Backups	3,000	
Registration, licences, contract templates, lawyer review	10,000	Sole proprietorship or small LLC plus one-off legal review
Accountant	24,000	About 2,000 EGP/month
Marketing, demo videos, printed material, photography	20,000	Heaviest early spend
Contingency (hardware spares, refunds, tools)	10,000	
Total fixed	**83,000**	Break-even before per-venue cost

Scenario (year 1)	4 venues	10 venues	25 venues
Licence revenue (35,000 average)	140,000	350,000	875,000
Per-venue cash cost (1,500 each)	6,000	15,000	37,500
Fixed cost (hosting scales up)	83,000	83,000	110,000
Profit before tax and your time	**51,000**	**252,000**	**727,500**
Year 2 support income (12% yearly, 40% of venues buy it)	about 6,700	about 16,800	about 42,000
Rough break-even	about 3 venues	about 3 venues	about 3 venues

Note: break-even is fixed cost divided by profit per venue: 83,000 / (35,000 - 1,500) is about 2.5, so 3 venues. Year-2 support figure assumes 40% of venues buy support at 12% of a 35,000 licence (4,200 each). These models exclude tax (corporate tax 22.5% [S] or the small-business regime), exclude your salary, and exclude the cost of building ETA integration, which may be 3-6 weeks of your time or an outside developer [E].

Cash flow tip

- Take 50% upfront on every sale. It funds setup and travel.
- Keep a 3-month cost reserve before expanding.
- Do not buy hardware stock; order for each venue after payment.

8. Risks and how to reduce them

Risk	Impact	What to do
ETA e-receipt becomes mandatory for your target venues	Cannot sell to covered venues	Ask at every first meeting; build ETA module early or partner
Data loss or breach	Lose trust and possibly face claims	Daily off-site backups, tested restore, rotated secrets, strong default passwords, rate-limited logins
Free support never ends	Time drain	Contract defines 1 month free support; paid support after; response times in writing
One-time price vs. ongoing hosting cost	You pay hosting for years	Prefer Model A (local) or let the venue pay hosting directly; or include 1 year hosting and charge yearly after
Pound moves against the dollar	Hosting in USD gets pricier	Quote expiry, price hosting in EGP with a margin, review prices every 6 months

Risk	Impact	What to do
Copying or resale of your software	Lost revenue	Licence terms, host it yourself, or deliver as a service not source code
Wi-Fi and device problems at venues	Bad reviews of your product	Use a test checklist, a cheap router recommendation, offline status messages, and a support WhatsApp number
Competitors with brands and ETA built in	Lose deals	Compete on one-time price, Arabic-first design, easy setup and local support

9. 90-day launch plan

When	Do this
Days 1-14	Register the business (sole proprietorship or LLC) and tax card with your accountant; open a business bank account; buy the domain; rotate all exposed keys and change default passwords; move off Vercel free; set up backups.
Days 15-30	Finish the local install package and multi-venue server; write the licence contract, invoice and handover checklist; record a 3-minute Arabic demo; test on real iPhones, Android phones and a tablet for a full shift.
Days 31-60	Run 2-3 pilot cafes at a discount; fix what real staff stumble on; collect photos and testimonials; ask each pilot whether they must issue ETA e-receipts.
Days 61-90	Publish a simple Arabic landing page and WhatsApp button; offer free demos; sell the first full-price venues; decide whether to build ETA integration or partner.
After 90 days	Add payments (Paymob or similar), shift close and Z-report, printer automation, loyalty; review pricing and costs.

10. Sources and honesty notes

Search results were gathered on 28 Oct 2026. Several pages are vendor marketing; figures conflict in places (noted above). Please verify with the vendor, ETA, GAFI, the Central Bank of Egypt and a local accountant before relying on any number.

POS pricing and hardware ranges: https://talabxy.com/en/blog/best-pos-system-for-restaurants-egypt-2026

POS software list for Egypt: https://www.softwaresuggest.com/point-of-sale-pos-software/egypt

Restaurant POS pricing in the Middle East: https://blog.slantco.com/restaurant-pos-pricing-in-the-middle-east/

Odoo Arabic POS Egypt: ETA e-receipt and pricing: https://www.2b-cs.com/blog/2b-1/odoo-arabic-pos-egypt-55

Online ordering plans (28,000 / 45,000 EGP per year): https://www.itsordable.com/en/egypt/pricing

PSR POS for cafes and restaurants: https://psr.com.eg/en/cafe-restaurants-solution1/

Queno (per-order fee model): https://www.queno.org/

Orders Egypt QR menu: https://www.orders-egypt.com/

OrOMenu QR menu: https://oromenu.com/en/

QR menu systems guide (300-1,500 EGP estimate): https://talabxy.com/en/blog/best-qr-menu-system-for-restaurants-egypt

E-invoicing in Egypt 2026 (ETA): https://dddinvoices.com/learn/e-invoicing-in-egypt

E-invoicing in Egypt: mandate status: https://e-invoicing.org/egypt/

Egypt e-invoicing and e-receipt guide for SMEs: https://datavalue.solutions/egypt-e-invoicing-eta-2026-sme-guide/

Best restaurant POS in Egypt and ETA: https://tappya.com/en/blog/best-restaurant-pos-egypt-comparison-2026

Egypt tax rates 2026: https://npiegypt.com/articles/guides/egypt-tax-rates-and-thresholds

KPMG: tax incentives for small businesses: https://kpmg.com/us/en/taxnewsflash/news/2025/03/tnf-egypt-amendments-to-tax-procedures-tax-incentives-for-small-businesses.html

Small and medium enterprises in Egypt (Andersen): https://eg.andersen.com/small-medium-enterprises/

Freelancer registration guide: https://enterpriseam.com/egypt/2026/10/11/your-guide-to-registering-as-a-freelancer-in-egypt/

Sole proprietorship registration: https://www.deel.com/blog/sole-proprietorship-egypt

GAFI e-services fees: https://www.gafi.gov.eg/English/eServices/Pages/eservicesInfograph.aspx

Company registration guide 2026: https://www.usemultiplier.com/egypt/company-registration

Paymob rate (2.75% + 3 EGP): https://yespress.io/paymob

Paymob alternatives comparison: https://dodopayments.com/blogs/paymob-alternatives

EGP/USD, Aug 2026: https://en.amwalalghad.com/?p=230053

Vercel vs Supabase pricing (Pro $20 / $25): https://www.jetadmin.io/blog/vercel-vs-supabase/

Supabase pricing 2026: https://makerkit.dev/blog/saas/supabase-pricing

Xprinter XP-Q838L price in Egypt: https://eg.pricena.com/en/product/xprinter-xp-q838l-80mm-thermal-receipt-printer-usb-price-in-Egypt-36225532

Not found or not verified: Foodics EGP price list beyond the Starter figure; official Fawry merchant rates; Egyptian cash-drawer and tablet prices; current GAFI fee schedule date; the exact ETA phase decision for cafes. These are marked as questions, not facts.